Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠10

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠9

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 8 3 ♥ A 7 ♦ K J 9 6 4 ♣ Q J 5	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 8 5 4 ♦ 10 7 3 2 ♣ A 9 4		♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 8 ♣ 7 6 3 2
	♠ K J 4 ♥ K Q 9 2 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ K 10 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North
Lead: ♠10

With balanced distribution and 16 points NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

SOUTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that NORTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 8 7 2 ♥ J 9 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ J 3 2	
♠ Q J 10 9 6 ♥ A 7 ♦ A Q 6 ♣ A K 7		♠ K 4 ♥ Q 10 6 ♦ 8 5 3 2 ♣ Q 9 8 5
	♠ 5 3 ♥ K 8 5 4 3 ♦ K J 4 ♣ 10 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥4

WEST is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

EAST does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

WEST is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K 9 6 4 ♥ K Q 5 ♦ K Q J 7 ♣ 3	
♠ 5 ♥ 7 3 ♦ 6 5 4 2 ♣ K Q 10 8 7 5		♠ 7 2 ♥ 10 9 8 6 2 ♦ 9 8 3 ♣ A J 4
	♠ Q J 10 8 3 ♥ A J 4 ♦ A 10 ♣ 9 6 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH has a minimum 1♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

NORTH hears the 1♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether SOUTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

SOUTH has two Aces so she bids 5♥ (5♣ would show zero Aces, 5♦ would show one Ace, etc).

NORTH has heard enough and bids 6♠.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K J 8 3 ♥ J 9 4 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ 10 4 2	
♠ 6 2 ♥ A K 8 7 6 2 ♦ A 10 3 ♣ A 9	N W E S	♠ A 7 4 ♥ Q 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ 7 6 5 3
	♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q J 9 ♣ K Q J 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♦2

WEST has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

EAST, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

WEST shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which EAST raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7 4
♥ 8 3
♦ 7 6 2
♣ A K Q 2

♠ A 6 5
♥ J 9 6 5
♦ K Q 8 4
♣ 10 3



♠ 9 2
♥ K 10 2
♦ A 10 9
♣ J 9 8 5 4

♠ J 10 8 3
♥ A Q 7 4
♦ J 5 3
♣ 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♠9

NORTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

SOUTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1♥.

NORTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and SOUTH again must bid. Since SOUTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2♠, which NORTH happily passes.